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Authentication device, authentication method, and recording medium

Abstract

An authentication device includes an image acquisition unit, an identification unit, and an authentication unit. The image acquisition unit acquires an image of an eye of a subject. The identification unit identifies the colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye. The authentication unit identifies the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in the iris region of the eye.

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Background/Summary

(1) This application is a Continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/280,448 filed on Mar. 26, 2021, which is a National Stage Entry of PCT/JP2018/036352 filed on Sep. 28, 2018, the contents of all of which are incorporated herein by reference, in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The example embodiments relates to an authentication device, an authentication method, and a recording medium.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) Iris authentication to authenticate individuals using an iris image is known. The iris that adjusts the opening diameter of the pupil has a pattern unique to each individual, and is said to remain unchanged throughout life. Therefore, by matching an iris image of a person to be authenticated against a previously registered iris image, the person can be authenticated. An example of a technique for reducing the influence of a contact lens worn by a person to be authenticated in such iris authentication is disclosed in, for example, PTL 1.

(3) In the technique of PTL 1, a shadow region caused by a contact lens is detected, a corrected image with the shadow region removed from an iris image is generated, and authentication is performed using the corrected image.

CITATION LIST

(4) [Patent Literature]

(5) [PTL 1] JP 2000-139878 A

SUMMARY

Technical Problem

(6) In recent years, colored contact lenses with a colored region provided in part of the contact lenses have been commercially available. Wearing colored contact lenses on eyes provides the decorative effect of changing the color of the irises and/or making the irises look larger, and thus colored contact lenses are increasingly popular. When a person to be authenticated is wearing colored contact lenses, an iris image of the person is different from a previously registered iris image, so that the authentication precision of iris authentication is reduced.

(7) In the above-described technique of PTL 1, a method of removing a shadow region caused by a contact lens is disclosed. However, a method of reducing the influence of a colored contact lens itself is not disclosed.

(8) It is an object of the example embodiments to provide an authentication device, an authentication method, and a recording medium that can prevent a reduction in the authentication precision of iris authentication even when a colored contact lens is worn.

Solution to Problem

(9) An authentication device according to an aspect of the example embodiments includes an image acquisition means for acquiring an image of an eye of a subject, an identification means for identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye, and an authentication means for identifying the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye.

(10) An authentication method according to an aspect of the example embodiments includes

acquiring an image of an eye of a subject, identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye, and identifying the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye.

(11) A computer-readable recording medium according to an aspect of the example embodiments causes a computer to execute a process including acquiring an image of an eye of a subject, identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye, and identifying the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye.

Advantageous Effects

(12) An advantageous effect of the example embodiments is to be able to prevent a reduction in the authentication precision of iris authentication even when a colored contact lens is worn.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a diagram showing an example of wearing a colored contact lens.

(2) FIG. 2 is a functional block diagram of an authentication system **1** according to a first example embodiment.

(3) FIG. 3 is a diagram showing an example of product information **211** according to the first example embodiment.

(4) FIG. 4 is a diagram showing an example of authentication information **221** according to the first example embodiment.

(5) FIG. 5 is a block diagram showing an example of a hardware configuration of an authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment.

(6) FIG. 6 is a flowchart showing an authentication process in the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment.

(7) FIG. 7 is a diagram showing an example of extraction of a corrected iris region **700** according to the first example embodiment.

(8) FIG. 8 is a diagram showing another example of extraction of the corrected iris region **700** according to the first example embodiment.

(9) FIG. 9 is a diagram showing an example of a screen showing an authentication result according to the first example embodiment.

(10) FIG. 10 is a functional block diagram of a characteristic configuration in the first example embodiment.

(11) FIG. 11 is a functional block diagram of an authentication system **2** according to a second example embodiment.

(12) FIG. 12 is a flowchart showing an authentication process in an authentication device **13** according to the second example embodiment.

(13) FIG. 13 is a diagram showing an example of extraction of a corrected iris region **700** according to the second example embodiment.

(14) FIG. 14 is a functional block diagram of an authentication system **3** according to a third example embodiment.

(15) FIG. 15 is a diagram showing an example of authentication information **223** according to the third example embodiment.

(16) FIG. 16 is a functional block diagram of an authentication system **4** according to a fourth example embodiment.

(17) FIG. 17 is a diagram showing an example of wearing information **231** according to the fourth example embodiment.

- (18) FIG. **18** is a flowchart showing an authentication process in an authentication device **11** according to the fourth example embodiment.
- (19) FIG. **19** is a functional block diagram of an analysis system **5** according to a fifth example embodiment.
- (20) FIG. **20** is a flowchart showing a process in the analysis system **5** according to the fifth example embodiment.
- (21) FIG. **21** is a functional block diagram of a surveillance system **6** according to a sixth example embodiment.
- (22) FIG. **22** is a diagram showing an example of surveillance information **311** according to the sixth example embodiment.
- (23) FIG. **23** is a diagram showing an example of notification destination information **321** according to the sixth example embodiment.
- (24) FIG. **24** is a flowchart showing a process in the surveillance system **6** according to the sixth example embodiment.

EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS

- (25) Example embodiments will be described in detail with reference to the drawings. In the drawings and the example embodiments described in the description, the same reference numerals are assigned to the same or similar components to omit description of them as appropriate.
- (26) FIG. **1** is a diagram showing an example of wearing a colored contact lens. In FIG. **1**, a colored contact lens **600** is worn on an eye **500**. The eye **500** includes a pupil **510** and an iris **520**. The colored contact lens **600** typically has a colored region **610** with an iris-mimicking colored pattern provided annularly in a position associated to the vicinity of the outer periphery of the iris **520** of the eye **500**. A region other than the colored region **610** is transparent. Thus, on the eye **500** on which the colored contact lens **600** is worn, the vicinity of the outer periphery of the iris **520** is covered by the colored region **610**.
- (27) In iris authentication, an image of the iris **520** when the colored contact lens **600** is not worn (hereinafter also referred to as an iris image) is registered. When a person to be authenticated is wearing the colored contact lens **600**, an image of a combined region of the region of the iris **520** (hereinafter also referred to as an iris region) and the colored region **610** is used as an iris image.

First Example Embodiment

- (28) A first example embodiment will be described.
- (29) First, a configuration of an authentication system **1** according to the first example embodiment will be described.
- (30) FIG. **2** is a functional block diagram of the authentication system **1** according to the first example embodiment. The authentication system **1** includes an authentication device **11**. The authentication device **11** includes an image acquisition unit **111**, an identification unit **121**, an extraction unit **131**, a feature value calculation unit **141**, an authentication unit **151**, a display unit **161**, a transmission unit **171**, and a storage unit **181**.
- (31) The image acquisition unit **111** acquires an image of an eye **500** of a subject of processing in the authentication device **11** (hereinafter also simply referred to as a subject).
- (32) The identification unit **121** compares reference images with the image of the eye **500** of the subject, to identify the colored pattern of a colored contact lens **600** worn by the subject.
- (33) In the first example embodiment, as the image of the eye **500** of the subject, an image of at least one eye **500** of both eyes **500** of the subject is used. As the reference images, images of the colored patterns of colored contact lens products (hereinafter also simply referred to as products) acquired from product catalogs, specifications, and the like of the products are used.
- (34) FIG. **3** is a diagram showing an example of product information **211** according to the first example embodiment. The product information **211** in FIG. **3** includes product identifiers “Pi” (i is, for example, an integer of one or more) for identifying colored contact lens products, and the colored patterns of the products associated with the product identifiers. The product information

211 is set in advance by an administrator or the like. Each product identifier may be the product model number, the product number, the serial number, the manufacturer's name, the product name, or a combination of them.

(35) The extraction unit **131** extracts a corrected iris region **700** of the subject from the image of the eye **500** of the subject. The corrected iris region **700** is a region other than a colored region **610** of the identified colored pattern in the region of the iris **520** in the image of the eye **500**.

(36) The feature value calculation unit **141** calculates a feature value representing a feature of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject.

(37) The authentication unit **151** matches the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject calculated by the feature value calculation unit **141** against feature values representing features of individuals' iris regions, to authenticate the subject. The feature value of each individual's iris region is calculated using an iris image acquired when a colored contact lens is not being worn on the individual's eye **500**. The feature value of each individual's iris region is set in advance in authentication information **221** by an administrator or the like.

(38) FIG. **4** is a diagram showing an example of the authentication information **221** according to the first example embodiment. The authentication information **221** in FIG. **4** includes individual identifiers "Uj" (j is, for example, an integer of one or more) for identifying individuals, and iris images of both eyes **500** of the individuals and feature values "FRj" and "FLj" calculated for the iris images, which are associated with the individual identifiers. The individual identifiers may be the individuals' names.

(39) The authentication unit **151** may authenticate a subject using a determination device created by machine learning with feature values of individuals' iris regions as learning data.

(40) The display unit **161** displays the authentication result to an administrator or the like.

(41) The transmission unit **171** transmits the authentication result to another device or the like.

(42) The storage unit **181** stores the product information **211** and the authentication information **221**.

(43) FIG. **5** is a block diagram showing an example of a hardware configuration of the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment. The authentication device **11** is, for example, a mobile phone, a smartphone, a computer such as a personal computer (PC), or an information communication terminal.

(44) The authentication device **11** includes a central processing unit (CPU) **101**, a random-access memory (RAM) **102**, a read-only memory (ROM) **103**, and a flash memory **104**. The authentication device **11** also includes a communication interface (I/F) **105**, a display device **106**, an input device **107**, and a camera **108**. The CPU **101**, the RAM **102**, the ROM **103**, the flash memory **104**, the communication I/F **105**, the display device **106**, the input device **107**, and the camera **108** are connected to each other via a bus **109**.

(45) In FIG. **5**, the components constituting the authentication device **11** are shown as an integrated device, but part of these functions may be constituted by an external device. For example, the camera **108** may be an external device different from a part constituting the functions of a computer including the CPU **101** and others.

(46) The CPU **101** performs a predetermined operation according to programs stored in the ROM **103**, the flash memory **104**, etc., and controls each component of the authentication device **11**. The RAM **102** is formed from a volatile storage medium, and provides a temporary memory area necessary for the operation of the CPU **101**. The ROM **103** is formed from a nonvolatile storage medium, and stores necessary information such as programs used for the operation of the authentication device **11**. The flash memory **104** is formed from a nonvolatile storage medium, and stores the product information **211** and the authentication information **221**.

(47) The communication I/F **105** is a module for performing wired or wireless communication with another device. The display device **106** is a display or the like, and displays moving images, still images, characters, etc. The input device **107** is a keyboard, buttons, a touch panel, or the like, and

is used by an administrator or the like to operate the authentication device **11**. The display device **106** and the input device **107** may be formed in one piece as a touch panel.

(48) The camera **108** is, for example, a digital camera using a complementary metal-oxide semiconductor (CMOS) image sensor, a charge-coupled device (CCD) image sensor, or the like, and takes an image of a subject to acquire an image of an eye **500** of the subject.

(49) Note that the hardware configuration shown in FIG. **5** is an example, and a device other than these may be added, or part of the devices may not be provided. Further, part of the devices may be replaced by another device having a similar function. Furthermore, part of the functions may be provided by another device via a network, or the functions constituting the example embodiment may be distributed among a plurality of devices to be implemented. For example, the flash memory **104** may be replaced by a hard disk drive (HDD), or may be replaced by a cloud storage.

(50) The CPU **101** controls the camera **108** to implement the function of the image acquisition unit **111**. The CPU **101** loads programs stored in the ROM **103** etc. into the RAM **102** and executes them, to implement the functions of the identification unit **121**, the extraction unit **131**, the feature value calculation unit **141**, the authentication unit **151**, and the transmission unit **171**. The CPU **101** controls the display device **106** to implement the function of the display unit **161**. The CPU **101** controls the flash memory **104** to implement the function of the storage unit **181**.

(51) Next, the operation of the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment will be described.

(52) Here, it is assumed that the storage unit **181** stores the product information **211** in FIG. **3** and the authentication information **221** in FIG. **4**.

(53) FIG. **6** is a flowchart showing an authentication process in the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment. FIG. **7** is a diagram showing an example of extraction of the corrected iris region **700** according to the first example embodiment.

(54) First, the image acquisition unit **111** acquires an image of an eye **500** of a subject (step **S101**).

(55) For example, the image acquisition unit **111** acquires an image of an eye **500** (right eye) on which a colored contact lens **600** is worn as shown in FIG. **7**.

(56) The identification unit **121** extracts an iris-like region from the image of the eye **500** acquired in step **S101** as an image to be processed (hereinafter also referred to as a subject image) (step **S102**). The “iris-like region” is a combined region of the region of an iris **520** and a colored region **610** when the colored contact lens **600** is being worn, or is the region of the iris **520** when the colored contact lens **600** is not being worn.

(57) For example, the identification unit **121** extracts the subject image from the image of the eye **500** as shown in FIG. **7**.

(58) The identification unit **121** compares the colored patterns of the products included in the product information **211** with the subject image extracted in step **S102**, to identify the product worn by the subject. The identification unit **121** identifies the colored pattern of the identified product as the colored pattern of the colored contact lens **600** being worn by the subject (step **S103**). Here, the identification unit **121** performs image matching between the colored patterns and the subject image while rotating the colored pattern of each product, to identify a product and a rotation angle with a high matching degree.

(59) For example, the identification unit **121** calculates a matching degree at each rotation angle while rotating the colored pattern of each product included in the product information **211** in FIG. **3** by a predetermined angle at a time in a predetermined rotation direction around a position associated to the center of the pupil **510**. The identification unit **121** identifies a product “**P1**” and a rotation angle “**X degrees**” with the largest matching degree equal to or more than a predetermined value as shown in FIG. **7**.

(60) As a method of the image matching, any method may be used as long as a matching degree between two images can be obtained. For example, as a matching degree, the sum total of differences between associated pixels, the number of pixels with the number of differences between

the pixels being equal to or less than a threshold value, or a correlation coefficient between images may be calculated. For a product that does not rotate when worn such as an astigmatic contact lens, or a product whose colored pattern does not change when rotated, the identification of a rotation angle may be omitted.

(61) The extraction unit **131** extracts a corrected iris region **700** of the subject from the subject image (step **S104**). Here, the extraction unit **131** superimposes the colored pattern identified in step **S103** on the subject image at the identified angle. Then, the extraction unit **131** extracts, as the corrected iris region **700**, a region obtained by removing the colored region **610** of the identified colored pattern from the subject image.

(62) For example, as shown in FIG. 7, the extraction unit **131** removes the colored region **610** of the identified product “**P1**” from the subject image, to extract the corrected iris region **700**.

(63) The extraction unit **131** may alternatively determine a maximum radius of the identified colored pattern not including the colored region **610** around a position associated to the center of the pupil **510**. Then, the extraction unit **131** may extract, as the corrected iris region **700**, a region obtained by removing the outside of a circle of the determined radius from the subject image.

(64) FIG. 8 is a diagram showing another example of extraction of the corrected iris region **700** according to the first example embodiment.

(65) In this case, for example, as shown in FIG. 8, the extraction unit **131** determines a maximum radius “**R**” not including the colored region **610** from the colored pattern of the identified product “**P1**”. Then, the extraction unit **131** extracts the corrected iris region **700** by removing the outside of a circle of the radius “**R**” from the subject image.

(66) The feature value calculation unit **141** calculates the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** extracted in step **S104** (step **S105**). Here, as the feature value, the feature value calculation unit **141** uses, for example, a bit string obtained by encoding an image of the corrected iris region **700** with a predetermined algorithm.

(67) For example, the feature value calculation unit **141** calculates a feature value “**FRt**” of the corrected iris region **700** shown in FIG. 7.

(68) The authentication unit **151** matches the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject calculated in step **S105** against the feature values of the individuals' iris regions included in the authentication information **221**, to authenticate the subject (step **S106**). Here, the authentication unit **151** matches the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject against the feature values of the individuals' iris regions on the eye **500** (right eye or left eye) corresponding to the subject image.

(69) For example, the authentication unit **151** matches the feature value “**FRt**” of the corrected iris region **700** against the feature values “**FRj**” of the individuals' iris regions in the authentication information **221** in FIG. 4, and identifies the subject as an individual “**U1**”.

(70) The display unit **161** displays the authentication result (step **S107**). Here, when an individual can be identified in step **S106**, the display unit **161** may display authentication success or the individual identifier of the identified subject as the authentication result. If an individual cannot be identified in step **S106**, the display unit **161** may display authentication failure as the authentication result.

(71) FIG. 9 is a diagram showing an example of a screen showing an authentication result according to the first example embodiment. The screen in FIG. 9 shows that, as the matching result, the subject is identified as the individual “**U1**”. In addition to the authentication result, the subject image, the identified product “**P1**” and colored pattern, the image (corrected iris image) and the feature value of the corrected iris region **700**, and the iris image and the feature value of the identified individual are shown.

(72) For example, the display unit **161** displays the screen in FIG. 9 as the authentication result.

(73) Thus, the operation of the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment is completed.

(74) If a colored pattern cannot be identified in step S103 described above, the identification unit **121** may determine that the colored contact lens **600** is not being worn on the eye **500** of the subject. In this case, the feature value calculation unit **141** calculates the feature value of the region of the iris **520** in the subject image, instead of the feature value of the corrected iris region **700**, and the authentication unit **151** authenticates the subject using the feature value.

(75) In step S106 described above, the authentication unit **151** may use, as the individuals' feature values to be matched against the feature value of the subject, feature values of the individuals' corrected iris regions that have been calculated on the assumption that the individuals wear the identified product. In this case, the authentication unit **151** extracts a corrected iris region from each individual's iris region included in the authentication information **221**, using the identified colored pattern in the same manner as in step S104, for example, to calculate the feature value of the corrected iris region.

(76) For example, the authentication unit **151** removes the colored region **610** of the colored pattern of the identified product identifier "P1" from each individual's iris region to extract a corrected iris region. The authentication unit **151** calculates a feature value "FR'j" of the corrected iris region of each individual. The authentication unit **151** matches the feature value "FRt" of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject against the feature value "FR'j" of the corrected iris region of each individual.

(77) Next, a characteristic configuration of the first example embodiment will be described.

(78) FIG. **10** is a functional block diagram of a characteristic configuration of the first example embodiment.

(79) The authentication device **11** includes the image acquisition unit **111**, the identification unit **121**, and the authentication unit **151**. The image acquisition unit **111** acquires an image of an eye of a subject. The identification unit **121** compares reference images with the image of the eye, to identify the colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject. The authentication unit **151** identifies the subject using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in the iris region of the eye.

(80) Next, the effect of the first example embodiment will be described.

(81) According to the first example embodiment, even when a colored contact lens is worn, a reduction in the authentication precision of iris authentication can be prevented. The reason is that the authentication device **11** identifies the colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by a subject by comparing reference images with an image of an eye, and identifies the subject using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in the iris region of the eye.

(82) According to the first example embodiment, a colored contact lens product being worn can be identified. The reason is that the authentication device **11** identifies a product being worn by a subject from a plurality of products by comparing the colored pattern of each of the plurality of products with an image of an eye of the subject. Thus, a colored contact lens product can be presented, for example, as information indicating one of articles being worn by a subject.

Second Example Embodiment

(83) Next, a second example embodiment will be described. The second example embodiment is different from the first example embodiment in that an image of one eye **500** of both eyes **500** of a subject is used as a reference image.

(84) First, a configuration of an authentication system **2** according to the second example embodiment will be described.

(85) FIG. **11** is a functional block diagram of the authentication system **2** according to the second example embodiment. The authentication system **2** includes an authentication device **12**. In the authentication device **12** according to the second example embodiment, the image acquisition unit **111**, the identification unit **121**, and the storage unit **181** in the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment are replaced by an image acquisition unit **112**, an identification unit **122**, and a storage unit **182**, respectively.

(86) The image acquisition unit **112** acquires images of both eyes **500** of a subject.

(87) The identification unit **122** compares the image of one eye **500** of both eyes **500** of the subject (reference image) with the image of the other eye **500**, to identify the colored pattern of colored contact lenses **600** worn by the subject. Generally, the colored contact lenses **600** of the same colored pattern are worn on both eyes **500**. On the other hand, the patterns of the irises **520** of the right and left eyes **500** are different from each other. Therefore, by comparing the images of both eyes **500** on which the colored contact lenses **600** are worn, the colored pattern can be identified.

(88) The storage unit **182** stores the authentication information **221**.

(89) Next, the operation of the authentication device **12** according to the second example embodiment will be described.

(90) Here, it is assumed that the storage unit **182** stores the authentication information **221** in FIG. 4.

(91) FIG. 12 is a flowchart showing an authentication process in the authentication device **12** according to the second example embodiment. FIG. 13 is a diagram showing an example of extraction of a corrected iris region **700** according to the second example embodiment.

(92) First, the image acquisition unit **112** acquires images of both eyes **500** of a subject (step **S201**).

(93) For example, the image acquisition unit **112** acquires images of both eyes **500** (the right eye and the left eye) on which colored contact lenses **600** are being worn as shown in FIG. 13.

(94) The identification unit **122** extracts a subject image of each eye **500** from the images of both eyes **500** acquired in step **S201** (step **S202**).

(95) For example, as shown in FIG. 13, the identification unit **122** extracts, from the images of both eyes **500**, a subject image of the right eye **500** and a subject image of the left eye **500**.

(96) The identification unit **122** compares the subject images of both eyes **500** extracted in step **S202**, to identify the colored pattern of the colored contact lenses **600** worn by the subject (step **S203**). Here, the identification unit **122** compares the subject images of both eyes **500** (performs image matching) while rotating the subject image of one eye **500**, to identify a rotation angle with a high matching degree. Then, the identification unit **122** identifies a region where the values of associated pixels are similar between the subject images of both eyes **500** when the subject image of one eye **500** is rotated to the identified rotation angle, as the colored region **610** of the colored pattern of the colored contact lenses **600**.

(97) For example, the identification unit **122** calculates a matching degree at each rotation angle while rotating the subject image of the left eye **500** by a predetermined angle at a time in a predetermined rotation direction around a position associated to the center of the pupil **510**. The identification unit **122** identifies a rotation angle “Y degrees” with the largest matching degree equal to or more than a predetermined value as shown in FIG. 13. The identification unit **122** calculates differences between the values of associated pixels between the subject images of both eyes **500** when the subject image of the left eye **500** is rotated to the identified rotation angle. As shown in FIG. 13, the identification unit **122** identifies a region where the differences are less than a predetermined value as the colored region **610**.

(98) In order to prevent a region not covered by the colored region **610** in the region of the iris **520** of the eye **500** from being erroneously identified as the colored region **610**, the identification unit **122** may identify the colored region **610** using differences between the values of associated pixels between the subject images as follows. For example, on circles of different radii around a position associated to the center of the pupil **510**, the identification unit **122** calculates the number of pixels in which differences in value between the subject images are less than a predetermined value, among the pixels on each circle. The identification unit **122** determines a circle with the calculated number of pixels equal to or more than a threshold value as a circle on the colored region **610**. The identification unit **122** determines the minimum radius of the radii of circles determined as circles on the colored region **610**. The identification unit **122** identifies the region outside the determined minimum radius as the colored region **610**.

(99) The extraction unit **131** extracts a corrected iris region **700** of the subject from the subject image (step **S204**).

(100) For example, as shown in FIG. **13**, the extraction unit **131** removes the colored region **610** of the identified colored pattern from the subject image of the right eye **500**, to extract the corrected iris region **700**.

(101) Thereafter, as in the first example embodiment, the feature value calculation unit **141** calculates the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** (step **S205**). Then, the authentication unit **151** authenticates the subject, using the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** (step **S206**), and the display unit **161** displays the authentication result (step **S207**).

(102) Thus, the operation of the authentication device **12** according to the second example embodiment is completed.

(103) Next, the effect of the second example embodiment will be described. According to the second example embodiment, a reduction in the authentication precision of iris authentication can be prevented without preparing product colored patterns or the like. The reason is that the authentication device **12** identifies the colored pattern of colored contact lenses by comparing an image of one eye of both eyes of a subject with an image of the other eye.

Third Example Embodiment

(104) Next, a third example embodiment will be described. The third example embodiment is different from the first example embodiment in that, as a feature value of each individual to be matched against in authentication, the feature value of a corrected iris region calculated in advance for each colored contact lens product is used instead of the feature value of an iris region.

(105) First, a configuration of an authentication system **3** according to the third example embodiment will be described.

(106) FIG. **14** is a functional block diagram of the authentication system **3** according to the third example embodiment. The authentication system **3** includes an authentication device **13**. In the authentication device **13** according to the third example embodiment, the authentication unit **151** and the storage unit **181** in the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment are replaced by an authentication unit **153** and a storage unit **183**, respectively.

(107) The authentication unit **153** matches the feature value of a corrected iris region of a subject against the feature value of a corrected iris region of each individual associated with an identified product, to authenticate the subject. The feature value of a corrected iris region of each individual for each product is calculated in advance by an administrator or the like on the assumption that the individual wears the product, and is set in authentication information **223**. In this case, a corrected iris region is extracted from each individual's iris region, using the colored pattern of each product in the same manner as in step **S104**, for example, and the feature value of the corrected iris region is calculated.

(108) FIG. **15** is a diagram showing an example of the authentication information **223** according to the third example embodiment. The authentication information **223** in FIG. **15** includes individual identifiers "Uj", and product identifiers "Pi" and feature values "FR'ji" and "FL'ji" calculated for corrected iris regions of both eyes **500** of the individuals, which are associated with the individual identifiers.

(109) The storage unit **183** stores the product information **211** and the authentication information **223**.

(110) Next, the operation of the authentication device **13** according to the third example embodiment will be described.

(111) Here, it is assumed that the storage unit **183** stores the product information **211** in FIG. **3** and the authentication information **223** in FIG. **15**.

(112) A flowchart showing an authentication process in the authentication device **11** according to the third example embodiment is the same as that of the first example embodiment (FIG. **6**) except for the processing in step **S106**.

(113) In step **S106**, the authentication unit **153** matches the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject calculated in step **S105** against the feature values of the corrected iris regions of the individuals associated with the product identified in step **S103** included in the authentication information **223**, to authenticate the subject.

(114) For example, when the product “**P1**” is identified, the authentication unit **153** matches the feature value “**FRt**” of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject against the feature values “**FR’jl**” of the corrected iris regions of the individuals associated with the product “**P1**”.

(115) In a case where the authentication unit **153** performs authentication using a determination device created by machine learning, a determination device associated with each product may be created using the feature values of corrected iris regions of individuals for the product as learning data.

(116) Thus, the operation of the authentication device **13** according to the third example embodiment is completed.

(117) Next, the effect of the third example embodiment will be described.

(118) According to the third example embodiment, the authentication precision of iris authentication when a colored contact lens is worn can be improved, compared to the first example embodiment. The reason is that the authentication device **13** matches the feature value of a corrected iris region of a subject against feature values of corrected iris regions of individuals associated with an identified product, to authenticate the subject.

Fourth Example Embodiment

(119) Next, a fourth example embodiment will be described. The fourth example embodiment is different from the first example embodiment in that an identified colored contact lens product is used to narrow down individuals to be matched against in an authentication process.

(120) First, a configuration of an authentication system **4** according to the fourth example embodiment will be described.

(121) FIG. **16** is a functional block diagram of the authentication system **4** according to the fourth example embodiment. The authentication system **4** includes an authentication device **14**. In the authentication device **14** according to the fourth example embodiment, the authentication unit **151** and the storage unit **181** in the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment are replaced by an authentication unit **154** and a storage unit **184**, respectively.

(122) When an individual is identified as a subject by the authentication process, the authentication unit **154** associates a product identified by the identification unit **121** with the identified individual (an individual who has worn the product) and stores them as wearing information **231**. Further, in the authentication process after that, the authentication unit **154** refers to the wearing information **231** to narrow down individuals to be matched against to individuals associated with a product identified by the identification unit **121**.

(123) FIG. **17** is a diagram showing an example of the wearing information **231** according to the fourth example embodiment. The wearing information **231** in FIG. **17** includes the product identifier “**Pi**” of each product associated with the individual identifiers “**Uj**” of individuals who have worn the product.

(124) The storage unit **184** stores the product information **211**, the authentication information **221**, and the wearing information **231**.

(125) Next, the operation of the authentication device **14** according to the fourth example embodiment will be described.

(126) Here, it is assumed that the storage unit **184** stores the product information **211** in FIG. **3** and the authentication information **221** in FIG. **4**.

(127) FIG. **18** is a flowchart showing the authentication process in the authentication device **11** according to the fourth example embodiment.

(128) Here, processing in steps **S401** to **S405** is the same as the processing in steps **S101** to **S105** of the first example embodiment.

- (129) The authentication unit **154** refers to the wearing information **231** to extract individuals associated with the product identified in step **S403** (step **S406**).
- (130) The authentication unit **154** matches the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject calculated in step **S405** against the feature values of the iris regions of the individuals extracted in step **S406** among the individuals included in the authentication information **221**, to authenticate the subject (step **S407**).
- (131) When an individual can be identified in step **S407** (step **S408/YES**), the display unit **161** displays, as the authentication result, authentication success or the individual identifier of the identified subject (step **S412**).
- (132) When an individual cannot be identified in step **S407** (step **S408/NO**), the authentication unit **154** matches the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject against the feature values of the iris regions of individuals other than the individuals extracted in step **S406** among the individuals included in the authentication information **221**, to authenticate the subject (step **S409**).
- (133) When an individual can be identified in step **S409** (step **S410/YES**), the authentication unit **154** associates the product identifier of the product identified in step **S403** with the individual identifier of the individual identified by the authentication in the wearing information **231** (step **S411**).
- (134) The display unit **161** displays, as the authentication result, authentication success or the individual identifier of the identified subject (step **S412**).
- (135) If an individual cannot be identified in step **S409** (step **S410/NO**), the display unit **161** displays authentication failure as the authentication result (step **S412**).
- (136) Thereafter, the process from step **S401** is repeated.
- (137) For example, assume that in the authentication process on a certain subject with no individual identifiers being associated with a product “P1” in the wearing information **231**, the product “P1” is identified by the identification unit **121**, and an individual “U1” by the authentication unit **154**. In this case, as shown in FIG. 17, the authentication unit **154** associates the individual “U1” with the product “P1” in the wearing information **231**. Further, assume that in the authentication process on another subject, the product “P1” and the individual “U1” are identified. In this case, as shown in FIG. 17, the authentication unit **154** associates an individual “U3” with the product “P1” in the wearing information **231**.
- (138) Assume that in the process on the same subject or another subject after that, the product “P1” is identified by the identification unit **121**. In this case, the authentication unit **154** extracts, from the wearing information **231** in FIG. 17, the individuals “U1”, “U3”, . . . associated with the product “P1”. The authentication unit **154** matches the feature value of the corrected iris region **700** of the subject against the feature values of the iris regions of the extracted individuals “U1”, “U3”, . . .
- (139) Thus, the operation of the authentication device **14** according to the fourth example embodiment is completed.
- (140) According to the fourth example embodiment, the authentication process can be performed in a shorter time than in the first example embodiment. The reason is that the authentication device **14** stores the identifiers of products associated with the identifiers of individuals who have worn the products, and narrows individuals to be matched against to individuals associated with an identified product.
- #### Fifth Example Embodiment
- (141) Next, a fifth example embodiment will be described. In the fifth example embodiment, the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment is used to identify a colored contact lens product worn by a customer in marketing or the like.
- (142) First, a configuration of an analysis system **5** according to the fifth example embodiment will be described.
- (143) FIG. 19 is a functional block diagram of the analysis system **5** according to the fifth example

embodiment. The analysis system 5 includes an analysis device 21 in addition to the authentication device 11 according to the first example embodiment. The analysis device 21 is, for example, a computer or an information communication terminal having a hardware configuration similar to that of the authentication device 11. The authentication device 11 and the analysis device 21 are connected by a network using wired or wireless communication or the like.

(144) The authentication device 11 is disposed in, for example, stores selling colored contact products, or the like. The analysis device 21 is disposed in, for example, an office or a data center of an administrative department managing the stores. Alternatively, the authentication device 11 and the analysis device 21 may be disposed in the same store.

(145) In a case where a customer visiting the store purchases a commodity, for example, with the customer as a subject, the authentication device 11 identifies a product worn by the subject, and authenticates the subject. The transmission unit 171 of the authentication device 11 transmits a product identifier identified by the identification unit 121 and an individual identifier identified by the authentication unit 151 to the analysis device 21.

(146) The analysis device 21 performs analytical processing on the individual wearing the product, using the product identifier and the individual identifier received from the authentication device 11.

(147) Next, the operation of the analysis system 5 according to the fifth example embodiment will be described.

(148) FIG. 20 is a flowchart showing a process in the analysis system 5 according to the fifth example embodiment.

(149) The authentication device 11 authenticates a customer by the same authentication process as in the first example embodiment (FIG. 6) (step S501).

(150) The transmission unit 171 of the authentication device 11 transmits a product identifier and an individual identifier identified in the authentication process to the analysis device 21 (step S502).

(151) The analysis device 21 performs analytical processing using the product identifier and the individual identifier received from the authentication device 11 (step S503).

(152) The analysis device 21 outputs the results of the analytical processing to an administrator or the like (step S504).

(153) The analytical processing is, for example, processing on each product to calculate the total number of individuals wearing the product.

(154) For example, based on product identifiers and individual identifiers received from the authentication device 11 during a predetermined period such as a day, a week, or a month, the analysis device 21 calculates the total number of individuals on each product for each predetermined period and for each store, and outputs them as the analysis results. The output analysis results are used, for example, to determine the number of each product to be purchased to sell at each store, and/or shelf allocation to each product.

(155) The analytical processing may be processing to analyze the relationship between each product and an individual's attribute data. Here, the individual's attribute data may be, for example, data on a commodity purchased by the individual at a store at the time of authentication, commodities or services purchased by the individual in the past, and/or the individual's hobbies and/or preferences. These pieces of data are associated with each individual's individual identifier and stored in a database in a data center or the like. The analysis device 21 acquires, from the data center or the like, data associated with an individual identifier received from the authentication device 11, to perform analytical processing. In addition to an individual's attribute data, various types of data such as the location where the authentication device 11 is installed, the date and time when the authentication process is performed, and the weather when the authentication process is performed may be analyzed for the relationship with each product.

(156) For example, based on product identifiers and individual identifiers received from the authentication device 11 during a predetermined period, the analysis device 21 creates a model on

each product which represents the correlation between the product and commodities purchased by the individuals wearing the product. When receiving a product identifier identified for a certain individual from the authentication device **11**, the analysis device **21** predicts a commodity having a high correlation with the product, using the created model. The analysis device **21** determines and presents the predicted commodity as a commodity to be recommended to the individual.

(157) Thus, the operation of the analysis system **5** according to the fifth example embodiment is completed.

(158) As the authentication device **11** according to the fifth example embodiment, instead of the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment, the authentication device **13** or **14** according to the third or fourth example embodiment may be used.

(159) The analytical processing of the fifth example embodiment may be analytical processing that does not require the identification of individuals. In this case, the analytical processing may be processing to calculate, on each product, the total number of subjects wearing the product. In this case, the analytical processing may be processing to analyze commodities purchased by subjects at a store and the above-described various types of data for the relationship with each product.

(160) In this case, instead of the authentication device **11**, a device of a configuration in which the extraction unit **131**, the feature value calculation unit **141**, and the authentication unit **151** are eliminated from the configuration of the authentication device **11** may be used.

(161) Next, the effect of the fifth example embodiment will be described.

(162) According to the fifth example embodiment, various analyses can be performed on individuals wearing colored contact lens products. The reason is that the authentication device **11** transmits identified product identifiers and individual identifiers to the analysis device **21**, and the analysis device **21** performs analytical processing using the received product identifiers and individual identifiers.

Sixth Example Embodiment

(163) Next, a sixth example embodiment will be described. In the sixth example embodiment, the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment is used to identify a colored contact lens product worn by a subject whose image has been taken by a surveillance camera or the like in a criminal investigation or the like.

(164) First, a configuration of a surveillance system **6** according to the sixth example embodiment will be described.

(165) FIG. **21** is a functional block diagram of the surveillance system **6** according to the sixth example embodiment. The surveillance system **6** includes, in addition to the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment, a surveillance device **31** and a terminal device **41**. The surveillance device **31** and the terminal device **41** are, for example, a computer or an information communication terminal having a hardware configuration similar to that of the authentication device **11**. The authentication device **11** and the surveillance device **31** are connected by a network using wired or wireless communication or the like. Similarly, the surveillance device **31** and the terminal device **41** are connected by a network using wired or wireless communication or the like.

(166) The camera **108** connected to the authentication device **11** is, for example, a surveillance camera, and is installed at a surveillance target place such as a road, a station, or a shopping center. The authentication device **11** and the surveillance device **31** are installed in, for example, an investigation agency such as the police. The terminal device **41** is installed in, for example, a store selling colored contact lens products.

(167) The authentication device **11** identifies a product being worn by a subject whose image has been taken by the camera **108**, and authenticates the subject. The transmission unit **171** of the authentication device **11** transmits a product identifier identified by the identification unit **121** and an individual identifier identified by the authentication unit **151** to the surveillance device **31**.

(168) The surveillance device **31** determines whether the individual identifier received from the

authentication device **11** is the individual identifier of an individual under surveillance, to detect the individual under surveillance. When the individual under surveillance is detected, the surveillance device **31** displays information about the detected individual to an administrator or the like together with the product identifier received from the authentication device **11**. The surveillance device **31** notifies the terminal device **41** that is a notification destination associated with the product, of the information about the detected individual together with the product identifier received from the authentication device **11**.

(169) The terminal device **41** displays, to a store clerk or the like, the information about the individual under surveillance received from the surveillance device **31**, together with the product identifier received from the authentication device **11**.

(170) FIG. **22** is a diagram showing an example of surveillance information **311** according to the sixth example embodiment. The surveillance information **311** in FIG. **22** includes the individual identifiers “Uj” of individuals under surveillance associated with information such as the individuals' names, sexes, and characteristics (heights and weights). FIG. **23** is a diagram showing an example of notification destination information **321** according to the sixth example embodiment. The notification destination information **321** in FIG. **23** includes product identifiers “Pi” associated with the identifiers “Sk” (k is, for example, an integer of one or more) of stores selling the products. The surveillance information **311** and the notification destination information **321** are set in advance in the surveillance device **31** by an administrator or the like.

(171) Next, the operation of the surveillance system **6** according to the sixth example embodiment will be described.

(172) Here, it is assumed that a storage unit of the surveillance device **31** stores the surveillance information **311** in FIG. **22** and the notification destination information **321** in FIG. **23**.

(173) FIG. **24** is a flowchart showing a process in the surveillance system **6** according to the sixth example embodiment.

(174) The authentication device **11** authenticates a subject by the same authentication process as in the first example embodiment (FIG. **6**) (step **S601**).

(175) The transmission unit **171** of the authentication device **11** transmits a product identifier and an individual identifier identified in the authentication process to the surveillance device **31** (step **S602**).

(176) For example, the transmission unit **171** transmits the product identifier “P1” and the individual identifier “U1” to the surveillance device **31**.

(177) The surveillance device **31** determines whether the individual identifier received from the authentication device **11** is the individual identifier of an individual under surveillance (step **S603**). Here, when the individual identifier received from the authentication device **11** matches one of the individual identifiers in the surveillance information **311**, the surveillance device **31** determines that the individual identifier received from the authentication device **11** is the individual identifier of an individual under surveillance.

(178) For example, the surveillance device **31** refers to the surveillance information **311** in FIG. **22**, and determines that the individual “U1” is under surveillance.

(179) If it is determined in step **S603** that the individual is under surveillance (step **S603**/YES), the surveillance device **31** displays, to an administrator or the like, information about the determined individual together with the product identifier received from the authentication device **11** (step **S604**). Here, the surveillance device **31** refers to the surveillance information **311** and acquires information about the individual determined as a surveillance target.

(180) For example, the surveillance device **31** refers to the surveillance information **311** in FIG. **22**, and displays the information about the individual “U1” “Name: AAA, Sex: Male, Height: 170 cm, Weight: 60 kg” and the product “P1”. Based on these pieces of information, the administrator or the like can collect a purchase history of the product “P1” and other commodities by the individual “U1” from stores selling the product “P”. Further, the administrator or the like can designate stores

selling the product “P1”, where the individual “U1” may visit, as places to be monitored by surveillance cameras or destinations to be staked out by investigators or the like.

(181) The surveillance device **31** notifies notification destination terminal devices **41** of the information on the individual determined as the surveillance target, together with the product identifier received from the authentication device **11** (step **S605**). Here, the surveillance device **31** refers to the notification destination information **321**, and notifies notification destination terminal devices **41** associated with the product identifier received from the authentication device **11**, of the individual's information and the product identifier.

(182) For example, the surveillance device **31** refers to the notification destination information **321** in FIG. **23**, and notifies stores “S1”, “S2”, . . . of the information about the individual “U1” “Name: AAA, . . .” and the product “P1”.

(183) The terminal devices **41** display the individual's information and the product identifier received from the surveillance device **31** (step **S606**).

(184) For example, the terminal device **41** in the store “S1” displays the information about the individual “U1” “Name: AAA, . . .” and the product “P1”. Based on these pieces of information, store employees or the like pay attention to whether a customer visiting the store or a customer who has purchased the product “P1” at the store is the individual “U1”, and can notify the investigation agency such as the police when a customer believed to be the individual “U1” visits.

(185) Thus, the operation of the surveillance system **6** according to the sixth example embodiment is completed.

(186) As the authentication device **11** according to the sixth example embodiment, instead of the authentication device **11** according to the first example embodiment, the authentication device **13** or **14** according to the third or fourth example embodiment may be used.

(187) In the sixth example embodiment, the identification of an individual may be performed by a method other than iris authentication. In this case, the authentication unit **151** of the authentication device **11** may identify an individual by a method other than iris authentication, such as face authentication or gait authentication.

(188) According to the sixth example embodiment, information on a colored contact lens product being worn can be used for criminal investigation or the like. The reason is that the authentication device **11** transmits a product identifier and an individual identifier identified to the surveillance device **31**, and the surveillance device **31** outputs the received product identifier if the received individual identifier is under surveillance.

(189) While the disclosure has been particularly shown and described with reference to exemplary embodiments thereof, the disclosure is not limited to these embodiments. It will be understood by those of ordinary skill in the art that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the example embodiments as defined by the claims.

(190) Part or all of the above-described example embodiments may be described as in the following Supplementary Notes, but are not limited to the following.

Supplementary Note 1

(191) An authentication device including: an image acquisition means for acquiring an image of an eye of a subject; an identification means for identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye; and an authentication means for identifying the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye.

Supplementary Note 2

(192) The authentication device according to Supplementary Note 1, in which the reference image is a colored pattern of one of a plurality of colored contact lens products, and the identification means identifies a product worn by the subject from the plurality of colored contact lens products by comparing a colored pattern of each of the plurality of products with the image of the eye, and identifies the colored pattern of the identified product as the colored pattern of the colored contact

lens worn by the subject.

Supplementary Note 3

(193) The authentication device according to Supplementary Note 2, further including: a storage means for storing an identifier for identifying an individual associated with an identifier for identifying a product and a feature in a region other than a colored region of a colored pattern of the product in an iris region of the individual, in which the authentication means identifies the subject by matching the feature in the region other than the colored region of the colored pattern of the identified product in the iris region of the subject against a feature in a region other than the colored region of the colored pattern of the identified product in the iris region of the individual stored in the storage means.

Supplementary Note 4

(194) The authentication device according to Supplementary Note 2, further including: a storage means for storing an identifier for identifying a product associated with an identifier for identifying an individual who has worn the product, in which the authentication means extracts an individual associated with the identified product stored in the storage means, and identifies the subject from the extracted individual.

Supplementary Note 5

(195) The authentication device according to Supplementary Note 1, in which the reference image is an image of one eye of both eyes of the subject, the image acquisition means acquires images of both eyes of the subject, and the identification means identifies the colored pattern of the colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing the image of one eye of both eyes with the image of the other eye.

Supplementary Note 6

(196) The authentication device according to any one of Supplementary Notes 1, 2, and 5, further including: a storage means for storing an identifier for identifying an individual associated with a feature in an iris region of the individual, in which the authentication means identifies the subject by matching the feature in the region other than the colored region of the identified colored pattern in the iris region of the subject against the feature in the iris region of the individual stored in the storage means.

Supplementary Note 7

(197) The authentication device according to any one of Supplementary Notes 1, 2, and 5, further including: a storage means for storing an identifier for identifying an individual associated with an iris region of the individual, in which the authentication means identifies the subject by matching the feature in the region other than the colored region of the identified colored pattern in the iris region of the subject against a feature in a region other than the colored region of the identified colored pattern in the iris region of the individual stored in the storage means.

Supplementary Note 8

(198) The authentication device according to any one of Supplementary Notes 2 to 4, further including: a transmission means for transmitting, to an analysis device, an identifier for identifying the identified product and an identifier for identifying an individual identified as the subject, in which the analysis device performs analytical processing on an individual wearing a product, using the identifier of the product and the identifier of the individual received from the authentication device.

Supplementary Note 9

(199) The authentication device according to Supplementary Note 8, in which as the analytical processing, the analysis device calculates, on each of the plurality of products, a total number of individuals wearing the product.

Supplementary Note 10

(200) The authentication device according to Supplementary Note 8, in which as the analytical processing, the analysis device analyzes, on each of the plurality of products, a relationship

between the product and an attribute of an individual wearing the product.

Supplementary Note 11

(201) The authentication device according to Supplementary Note 10, in which the attribute of the individual is a commodity purchased by the individual, and the analysis device determines a commodity to be presented to the subject wearing the identified product, based on the analyzed relationship.

Supplementary Note 12

(202) The authentication device according to any one of Supplementary Notes 2 to 4, further including: a transmission means for transmitting, to a surveillance device, an identifier for identifying the identified product and an identifier for identifying an individual identified as the subject, in which the surveillance device stores an identifier for identifying an individual under surveillance, and outputs the identifier of the product received from the authentication device when the identifier of the individual received from the authentication device matches the identifier of the individual under surveillance.

Supplementary Note 13

(203) The authentication device according to Supplementary Note 12, in which the surveillance device further stores the identifier for identifying the product associated with an identifier for identifying a notification destination, and notifies the notification destination associated with the identifier of the product received from the authentication device, of the identifier of the product when the identifier of the individual received from the authentication device matches the identifier of the individual under surveillance.

Supplementary Note 14

(204) An authentication method including: acquiring an image of an eye of a subject; identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye; and identifying the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye.

Supplementary Note 15

(205) A computer-readable recording medium that causes a computer to execute a process including: acquiring an image of an eye of a subject; identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye; and identifying the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(206) **1, 2, 3, 4** authentication system **5** analysis system **6** surveillance system **11, 12, 13, 14** authentication device **21** analysis device **31** surveillance device **41** terminal device **101** CPU **102** RAM **103** ROM **104** flash memory **105** communication I/F **106** display device **107** input device **108** camera **109** bus **111, 112** image acquisition unit **121, 122** identification unit **131** extraction unit **141** feature value calculation unit **151, 153, 154** authentication unit **161** display unit **171** transmission unit **181, 182, 183, 184** storage unit **211** product information **221, 223** authentication information **231** wearing information **311** surveillance information **321** notification destination information **500** eye **510** pupil **520** iris **600** colored contact lens **610** colored region

Claims

1. An authentication device comprising: a memory storing instructions; and at least one processor configured to execute the instructions to perform: acquiring an image of an eye of a subject; identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye; authenticating the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye, wherein the reference image is a colored pattern of one of a plurality of colored contact lens products; identifying a product worn by

the subject from the plurality of colored contact lens products by performing image matching between a colored pattern of each of the plurality of products and the image of the eye while rotating the colored pattern of the plurality of products by a predetermined angle, and identifying the colored pattern of the identified product as the colored pattern of the colored contact lens worn by the subject; storing an identifier for identifying an individual associated with an identifier for identifying a product and a feature in a region other than a colored region of a colored pattern of the product in an iris region of the individual; and identifying the subject by matching the feature in the region other than the colored region of the colored pattern of the identified product in the iris region of the subject against a feature in a region other than the colored region of the colored pattern of the identified product in the iris region of the individual stored in a storage.

2. The authentication device according to claim 1, further comprising: the storage storing an identifier for identifying a product associated with an identifier for identifying an individual who has worn the product, wherein the at least one processor is further configured to execute the instructions to perform: extracting an individual associated with the identified product stored in the storage, and authenticating the subject from the extracted individual.

3. The authentication device according to claim 1, wherein the reference image is an image of one eye of both eyes of the subject, the at least one processor is configured to execute the instructions to perform: acquiring images of both eyes of the subject, and identifying the colored pattern of the colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing the image of one eye of both eyes with the image of the other eye.

4. The authentication device according to claim 1, further comprising: the storage storing an identifier for identifying an individual associated with a feature in an iris region of the individual, wherein the at least one processor is configured to execute the instructions to perform: identifying the subject by matching the feature in the region other than the colored region of the identified colored pattern in the iris region of the subject against the feature in the iris region of the individual stored in the storage.

5. The authentication device according to claim 1, further comprising: the storage storing an identifier for identifying an individual associated with an iris region of the individual, wherein the at least one processor is configured to execute the instructions to perform: identifying the subject by matching the feature in the region other than the colored region of the identified colored pattern in the iris region of the subject against a feature in a region other than the colored region of the identified colored pattern in the iris region of the individual stored in the storage.

6. The authentication device according to claim 1, wherein: the at least one processor is further configured to execute the instructions to perform: transmitting, to an analysis device, an identifier for identifying the identified product and an identifier for identifying an individual identified as the subject, wherein the analysis device performs analytical processing on an individual wearing a product, using the identifier of the product and the identifier of the individual received from the authentication device.

7. The authentication device according to claim 6, wherein as the analytical processing, the analysis device calculates, on each of the plurality of products, a total number of individuals wearing the product.

8. The authentication device according to claim 6, wherein as the analytical processing, the analysis device analyzes, on each of the plurality of products, a relationship between the product and an attribute of an individual wearing the product.

9. The authentication device according to claim 8, wherein the attribute of the individual is a commodity purchased by the individual, and the analysis device determines a commodity to be presented to the subject wearing the identified product, based on the analyzed relationship.

10. The authentication device according to claim 1, wherein: the at least one processor is further configured to execute the instructions to perform: transmitting, to a surveillance device, an identifier for identifying the identified product and an identifier for identifying an individual

identified as the subject, wherein the surveillance device stores an identifier for identifying an individual under surveillance, and outputs the identifier of the product received from the authentication device in a case where the identifier of the individual received from the authentication device matches the identifier of the individual under surveillance.

11. The authentication device according to claim 10, wherein the surveillance device further stores the identifier for identifying the product associated with an identifier for identifying a notification destination, and notifies the notification destination associated with the identifier of the product received from the authentication device, of the identifier of the product in a case where the identifier of the individual received from the authentication device matches the identifier of the individual under surveillance.

12. An authentication method performed by a computer and comprising: acquiring an image of an eye of a subject; identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye; authenticating the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye, wherein the reference image is a colored pattern of one of a plurality of colored contact lens products; identifying a product worn by the subject from the plurality of colored contact lens products by performing image matching between a colored pattern of each of the plurality of products and the image of the eye while rotating the colored pattern of the plurality of products by a predetermined angle, and identifying the colored pattern of the identified product as the colored pattern of the colored contact lens worn by the subject; storing an identifier for identifying an individual associated with an identifier for identifying a product and a feature in a region other than a colored region of a colored pattern of the product in an iris region of the individual; and identifying the subject by matching the feature in the region other than the colored region of the colored pattern of the identified product in the iris region of the subject against a feature in a region other than the colored region of the colored pattern of the identified product in the iris region of the individual stored in a storage.

13. A non-transitory computer-readable recording medium storing a program executable by that causes a computer to perform a process comprising: acquiring an image of an eye of a subject; identifying a colored pattern of a colored contact lens worn by the subject by comparing a reference image with the image of the eye; authenticating the subject, using a feature in a region other than a colored region of the colored pattern in an iris region of the eye, wherein the reference image is a colored pattern of one of a plurality of colored contact lens products; identifying a product worn by the subject from the plurality of colored contact lens products by performing image matching between a colored pattern of each of the plurality of products and the image of the eye while rotating the colored pattern of the plurality of products by a predetermined angle, and identifying the colored pattern of the identified product as the colored pattern of the colored contact lens worn by the subject; storing an identifier for identifying an individual associated with an identifier for identifying a product and a feature in a region other than a colored region of a colored pattern of the product in an iris region of the individual; and identifying the subject by matching the feature in the region other than the colored region of the colored pattern of the identified product in the iris region of the subject against a feature in a region other than the colored region of the colored pattern of the identified product in the iris region of the individual stored in a storage.
